

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

S	H	O	O	K
S	P	A	C	E

Ladder 2

P	H	O	N	E
S	T	A	C	K

Ladder 3

S	P	I	K	E
W	H	O	S	E

Ladder 4

S	C	O	R	E
S	K	I	L	L

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	H	O	O	K
S	H	O	C	K
S	H	A	C	K
S	H	A	R	K
S	P	A	R	K
S	P	A	R	E
S	P	A	C	E

Ladder 2

P	H	O	N	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	T	O	N	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	O	R	K
S	T	O	C	K
S	T	A	C	K

Ladder 3

S	P	I	K	E
S	P	I	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	L	E
W	H	O	L	E
W	H	O	S	E

Ladder 4

S	C	O	R	E
S	C	A	R	E
S	C	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	I	L	L
S	K	I	L	L